

USER MANUAL

Document Title	User Manual
System Name	Automatic Student Attendance System
Version	1.0
Target User	Lecturer / Teacher
Platform	Web Application (Any Modern Browser)
Attendance Method	Face Recognition

Quick-Start Guide

Following this a 5 steps quick start guide to take your first attendance under 2 minutes.

Step	Action	Description
1	Log In	Go to the system URL in any browser. Enter your institutional username and password, then click Login.
2	Select Your Class	From the dashboard, choose the enrolled class you want to take attendance for.
3	Click Capture	Click the Capture button. The camera will activate and the system will automatically identify students using face recognition.
4	Attendance Recorded	The system marks each recognised student as Present or Absent instantly. An email notification is automatically sent to each student.
5	View in Analytics	Navigate to the Analytics page to see a pie chart for the week or a line chart for the full semester, and generate a PDF report.

Introduction

1.1 Purpose of This Manual

This User Manual gives step-by-step guide for Lecturers using the **Automatic Student Attendance System** (ASAS). The system automates the student attendance using face recognition technology through any standard web browser, eliminating the need for paper-based or manual roll calls.

1.2 System Overview

ASAS is a web-based application that uses facial recognition to identify enrolled students and automatically mark their attendance as Present or Absent. Once attendance is captured, the system sends each student an email confirming their attendance status for that class. Lecturers can review attendance records, track trends over time, manually override attendances, and generate PDF reports all from the Analytics page.

1.3 What to Expect from Face Recognition

Face recognition works automatically when the Capture button is clicked. The camera scans the students present in view and matches faces against enrolled student profiles. To get the best results:

- Ensure the room is adequately lit avoid strong backlighting.
- Students should be facing the camera when capture is initiated.
- Only students who are enrolled in the selected class will be recognised.
- The system marks students not detected during capture as Absent. Lecturers can override this manually if need be.

1.4 Intended Audience

The manual is written for Lecturers and Teaching Staff who will use the system to capture attendance, review records, override attendances, and generate reports for their enrolled classes.

2. System Requirements

The system runs entirely in the browser. No software installation is needed. Make sure your device meets the following requirements:

Web Browser	Any modern browser (Chrome, Firefox, Edge, Safari, etc.)
Internet Connection	Stable broadband connection (minimum 5 Mbps recommended)
Camera	Built-in or external webcam (HD 720p or higher recommended)
Operating System	Windows 10/11, macOS 10.14+, or Ubuntu 18.04+
Screen Resolution	1280 x 720 or higher
JavaScript	Must be enabled in the browser
Camera Permission	Browser must be granted camera access

2.1 Enabling Camera Permission

The Capture feature requires camera access. If your browser prompts for permission when you first use Capture, click Allow. If you previously denied access, follow these steps:

Chrome / Edge

1. Click the padlock icon in the address bar.
2. Select Site Settings.
3. Set Camera to Allow, then refresh the page.

Firefox

1. Click the padlock icon in the address bar.
2. Click More Information, then go to the Permissions tab.
3. Set Use the Camera to Allow, then refresh the page.

3. Accessing the System

3.1 Opening the Application

- Open any web browser on your computer.
- Type the system URL provided by your institution into the address bar and press Enter.
- The Login page will load automatically.

3.2 Logging In

Step	Action	Description
1	Open Login Page	Navigate to the system URL. The login page will load automatically.
2	Enter Username	Type your institutional username or registered email address.
3	Enter Password	Type your password. The password is case-sensitive.
4	Click Login	Click the Login button. The system will verify your credentials.
5	Access Dashboard	On successful login, you will be taken to the Lecturer Dashboard.

NOTE — Login Issues

- If you have forgotten your password, click Forgot Password on the login page and follow the reset instructions sent to your registered email.
- After multiple failed login attempts, your account may be temporarily locked. Contact your System Administrator to unlock it.

4. Dashboard

After logging in, you will land on the Dashboard. This is the central hub of the system from which you can access all features.

Enrolled Classes	Displays the list of classes you are assigned to teach. Select a class to begin capturing attendance.
Recent Sessions	Shows a summary of your most recently captured attendance sessions.
Quick Actions	Shortcut buttons to capture attendance, view analytics, or generate a report.
Navigation Menu	Access all system modules: Dashboard, Capture, and Analytics.

Dashboard

Overview of current class attendance.

Key Attendance Metrics [No currently running classes]

+ Add

My Classes

Capture Attendance

Capture Time ▼

5. Capturing Attendance

Attendance is captured in a single step using the Capture button. The system uses face recognition to automatically identify enrolled students and record their status instantly.

5.1 How to Capture Attendance

Step	Action	Description
1	Go to Dashboard	From the navigation menu, click Dashboard or select your enrolled class directly.
2	Select a Class	Click on the enrolled class for which you want to capture attendance.
3	Click Capture	Click the Capture button. The camera will activate and begin scanning for student faces.
4	Automatic Recognition	The system identifies enrolled students in real time and marks each one as Present or Absent automatically.
5	Attendance Saved	Once capture is complete, attendance records are saved instantly. Each student receives an email notification of their status.

NOTE — After Capture

- The capture process runs once when the button is clicked — there is no ongoing session to stop.
- Every enrolled student in the selected class who is not detected by the camera is automatically marked Absent.
- An email is sent to each student immediately after capture, informing them whether they are marked Present or Absent in their enrolled class.
- If a student was incorrectly marked, you can manually override their status from the Analytics page (see Section 7).

6. Attendance Statuses

The system records two attendance states for each student per capture:

Present	The student's face was successfully recognised by the system during the capture.
Absent	The student's face was not detected during the capture. The student is also notified by email.

Both states are reflected in the Analytics page and contribute to the student's overall attendance percentage for the semester.

7. Analytics

The Analytics page is for reviewing attendance records, visualising trends, overriding attendances, and generating reports.

Analytics

Attendance stats by session, class, time, and week.

Class

Autumn 2026 - CSCI323 - Modern Artific ▾

Week

All Weeks ▾

Generate Report

7.1 Navigating to Analytics

- Click Analytics in the navigation menu.
- Select the week you wish to review.

7.2 Attendance Charts

The Analytics page displays two types of charts:

Pie Chart	Shows the attendance breakdown (Present vs Absent) for a selected week, for example Week 3. This gives a quick snapshot of a single week's attendance.
Line Chart	Displays attendance trends over the entire semester or session. Each data point represents one capture, allowing you to track attendance patterns over time.

Use the week selector on the Analytics page to switch between weeks on the pie chart. The line chart updates automatically to reflect the full semester view. (select All Weeks for line chart.)

7.3 Manual Override

If a student was incorrectly marked during capture or not recorded, the lecturer can manually correct their attendance status directly on the Analytics page.

Step	Action	Description
1	Open Analytics	Navigate to the Analytics page and select the relevant class and week.
2	Locate the Student	Find the student in the attendance list displayed below the charts.
3	Click Present or Absent	Each student has two clickable buttons: Present and Absent. Click the correct status to update it.
4	Percentage Updates	The attendance percentage for that student updates automatically, reflecting the corrected status. This will affect their final semester attendance record.

IMPORTANT — Manual Override

- Manual overrides are permanent and immediately affect the student's overall attendance percentage for the semester.
- Overriding a status also triggers an updated email notification to the student reflecting the corrected attendance.
- Use manual override carefully, as attendance percentages are used to determine student eligibility at the end of the semester.

#	Student ID	Email	Name	Week	Status	
1	8070799	aba193@uowmail.edu.au	Alyan Babar ALAM	Week 1	Absent	Present
2	8359118	et485@uowmail.edu.au	Ernest TEH	Week 1	Absent	Present
3	9782503	efzx084@uowmail.edu.au	Eric Zhi Xian FOO	Week 1	Absent	Present
4	9783210	ps603@uowmail.edu.au	Puvannesan SANDRANESAN	Week 1	Absent	Present

8. Generating Reports

Lecturers can generate a PDF report of attendance records directly from the Analytics page. The report includes the student attendance list, the pie chart, and the line chart based on the selected options.

Step	Action	Description
1	Go to Analytics	Navigate to the Analytics page from the navigation menu.
2	Select Class & Period	Choose the enrolled class and the time period (week or full semester) you want to include in the report.
3	Click Generate Report	Click the Generate Report button on the Analytics page. The system will compile the report based on your selected options.
4	PDF Downloaded	A PDF file will automatically download to your device, containing the attendance student list along with the pie chart and line chart.

NOTE — Report Contents	
•	The downloaded PDF includes the student attendance list (name, student ID, and status), the pie chart showing Present vs Absent for the selected week, and the line chart showing attendance trends for the full semester.
•	The report reflects any manual overrides that have been applied prior to generating it.
•	Reports are exported in PDF format only.

Analytics

Attendance stats by session, class, time, and week.

Class

Autumn 2026 - CSCI323 - Modern Artific

Week

All Weeks

Generate Report

9. Student Email Notifications

The system automatically sends an email to each enrolled student after every attendance capture. The email notifies the student whether they were marked Present or Absent in their enrolled class for that session.

Trigger	Sent automatically after every Capture action.
Recipient	Each enrolled student in the selected class.
Content	Student name, class name, date of capture, and attendance status (Present or Absent).
Override Notification	If a lecturer manually overrides a student's status, an updated email is sent to reflect the change.

NOTE

- Email notifications are sent to the student's registered institutional email address.
- Lecturers do not need to take any action to trigger notifications — they are sent automatically by the system.

10. Logging Out

Always log out after each use to protect your account and student data.

Step	Action	Description
1	Click Your Profile	Click your name or profile icon at the top-right corner of any page.
2	Select Logout	Click Logout from the dropdown menu.
3	Session Ended	The system will end your session and return you to the Login page.

SECURITY REMINDER

- Always log out when using a shared or public computer.
- Do not share your login credentials with anyone.
- The system will automatically log you out after a period of inactivity.

11. Troubleshooting

Issue	Possible Cause	Solution
Camera not activating	Browser camera permission denied	Enable camera access in browser settings (see Section 2.1)
Cannot log in	Incorrect credentials or account locked	Reset password or contact System Administrator
Student not recognised	Poor lighting or student not enrolled	Improve room lighting or verify student is enrolled in the class
Student incorrectly marked	Recognition error during capture	Use the Present or Absent buttons in Analytics to override manually
Student did not receive email	Email not registered or spam folder	Ask student to check spam, or verify their email with System Administrator
Page not loading	Slow internet or browser cache issue	Check internet connection and clear browser cache (Ctrl+Shift+Delete)
Report not downloading	Pop-up blocker active	Allow pop-ups for this site in browser settings

12. Glossary

ASAS	Automatic Student Attendance System — the name of this system.
Capture	The action of clicking the Capture button to initiate face recognition and record attendance for a selected class.
Face Recognition	A technology that identifies individuals by analysing facial features captured via the camera.
Present	Attendance status indicating the student was identified during the capture.
Absent	Attendance status indicating the student was not identified during the capture.
Manual Override	The ability for a lecturer to correct a student's attendance status using the Present or Absent buttons on the Analytics page.
Analytics	The system page where attendance charts, records, manual overrides, and report generation are available.

Pie Chart	A chart on the Analytics page showing Present vs Absent for a selected week.
Line Chart	A chart on the Analytics page showing attendance trends over the full semester.
Generate Report	A button on the Analytics page that downloads a PDF of the attendance records, pie chart, and line chart.
Enrolled Class	A class that a student is officially registered in within the system.

13. Support & Contact

If you encounter any issues not addressed in this manual, please contact your institution's IT support team or System Administrator.

SUPPORT INFORMATION	
•	Contact your System Administrator for account-related issues such as password resets or access problems.
•	For technical issues with the web application, contact your institution's IT Helpdesk.
•	For issues with face recognition accuracy or student enrolment, consult the System Administrator responsible for the ASAS database.